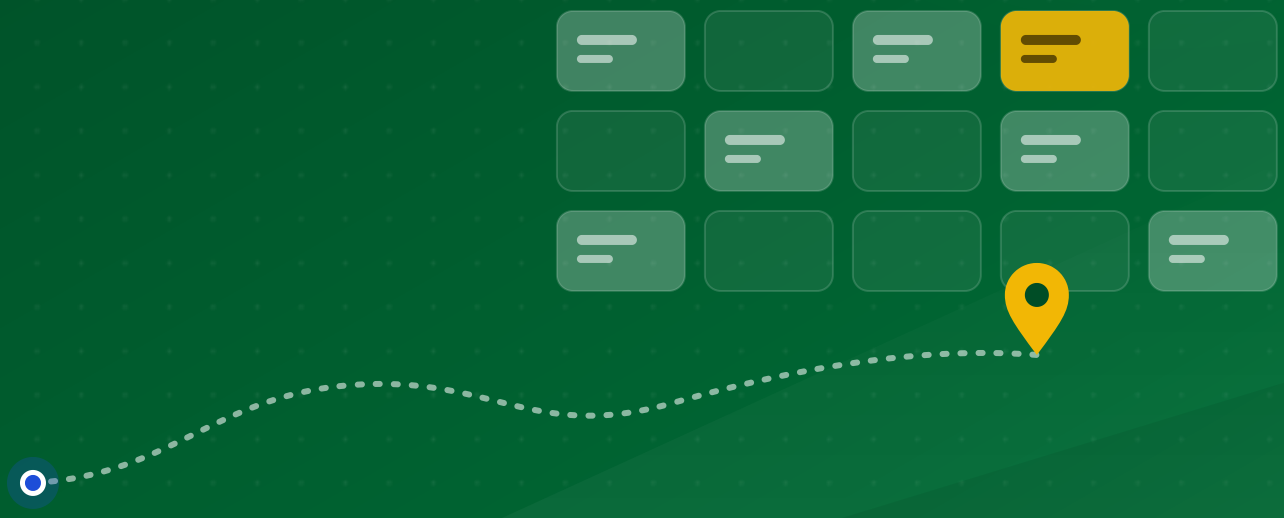
Yaba College of Technology
Labore et Veritate

EXAMS OFFICE GUIDE

YCT Exam Portal

Smart Examination Timetable Generator & Real-Time Hall Navigation

Yaba College of Technology · School of Technology,
Department of Computer Science (pilot)



Exams Office Guide · October 2026
For exams officers and portal administrators

SIGN IN AT
`smart-exam-timetable.vercel.app/login`

EXAMS OFFICE GUIDE

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Set up
structure, halls and the session

Generate
slots, schedule, halls and seats in one click

Review
department by department; Edit Slot

Publish
students see exam, hall and seat

ABOUT THIS GUIDE

This handout is for exams officers and administrators of YCT Exam Portal. It explains every screen of the Exams Office portal and walks through a complete exam period. Screens shown are illustrations with sample data; on-screen labels are quoted exactly as they appear in the app.

1 Your role and signing in

What an exams officer does in the portal, and how to get started.

As an exams officer you keep the college's academic structure and exam halls up to date, prepare each semester's session, generate the examination timetable, review and publish it, and look after student accounts. Students then see their own exams, halls and seats on their phones.

Your account

Admin accounts are created by the system administrator, not by public sign-up. Exams officers and the super admin (the first account, created during setup) have the same permissions.

Signing in

Open `/login`, enter your email and password, and you are taken to the **Dashboard**. If you followed a link to a particular admin page, you return to it after signing in.

Signing out

Use the **Sign out** button at the bottom of the sidebar, next to your email and role, especially on shared computers.

The portal layout

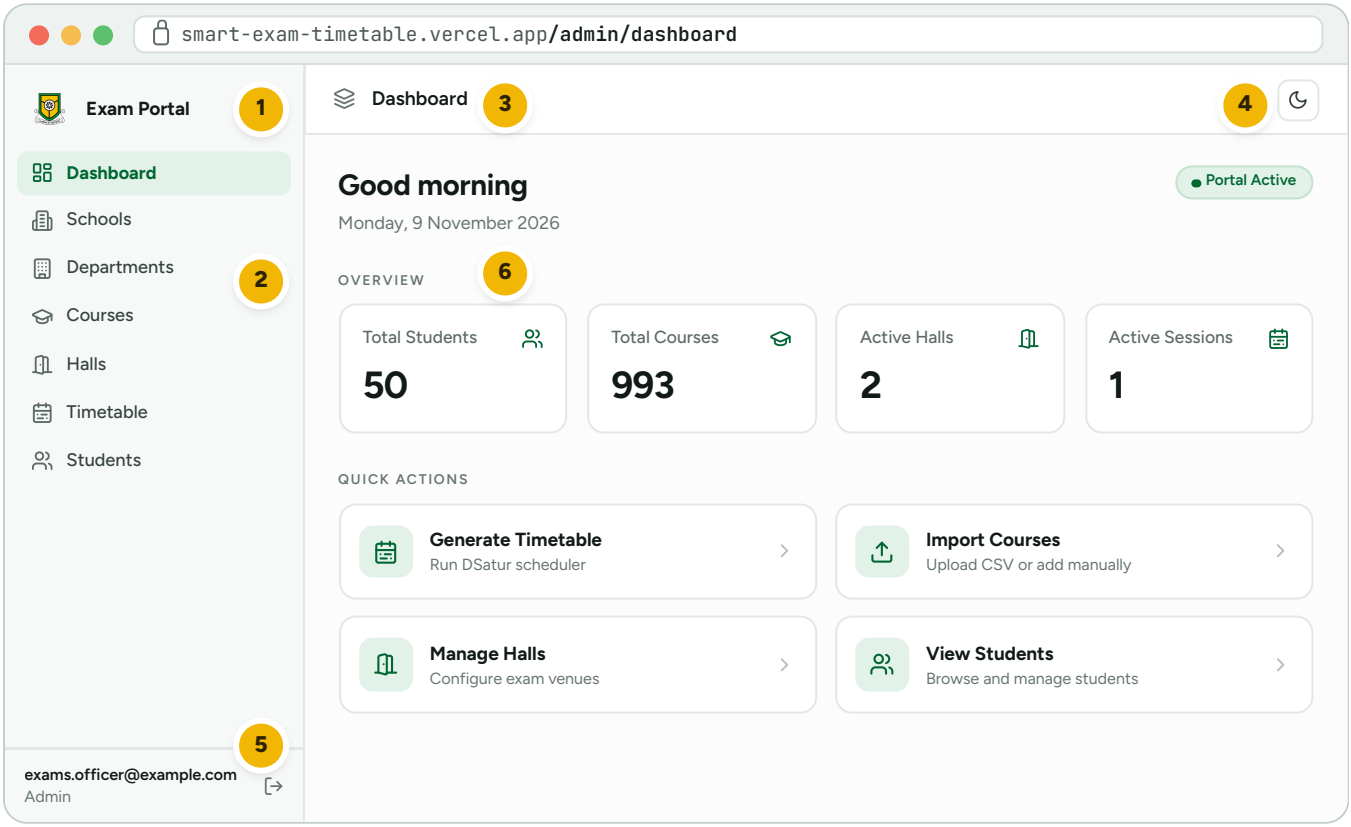


Figure 1. The Exams Office portal, with its main areas numbered. ILLUSTRATION (SAMPLE DATA)

1. **Crest and title**: the top of the sidebar.
2. **Menu**: Dashboard, Schools, Departments, Courses, Halls, Timetable, Students. Ctrl/Cmd + B collapses it to icons; on a phone it slides in from the side.
3. **Page name**: shows which screen you are on.
4. **Light/dark switch**: changes the colour theme.
5. **Your account**: signed-in email and role, with **Sign out**.
6. **Page content** (here the Dashboard): four headline figures and the quick actions *Generate Timetable, Import Courses, Manage Halls, View Students*.

2 Screen reference

Each screen of the Exams Office portal: what it is for and what you can do there.

Every list is a sortable table on a computer and a set of cards on a phone. The portal asks for confirmation before anything is deleted, and every action shows a short success or error message.

Screen	Purpose	Main actions
Dashboard	A summary as soon as you sign in.	Greeting and today's date; stat cards *Total Students, Total Courses, Active Halls, Active Sessions*; quick actions *Generate Timetable, Import Courses, Manage Halls, View Students*.
Schools	The top of the academic structure (e.g. School of Technology, SOT).	Add, edit and delete schools (name and code).
Departments	Departments within each school (e.g. Computer Technology, CSC).	Filter by school. **Add Department** also creates its two programmes, "National Diploma (ND)" and "Higher National Diploma (HND)", and the four levels ND 1, ND 2, HND 1, HND 2. **Upload CSV** (see section 5) with an import report.
Courses	The course catalogue the timetable is built from.	Cascading filters School → Department → Programme → Level; columns Code, Title, Level, Credits, Semester; pages of 50. **Add Course** (code, title, credit units 1-6, First or Second semester, level); **Upload CSV** (existing codes are updated) with an import report.
Halls	The exam venues used for seating and shown on students' maps.	Columns Name, Code, Capacity, Coordinates, Status. **Add Hall**: name, code, capacity, latitude, longitude, description and Active. Inactive halls are not used for new timetables and are hidden from students' hall list.
Timetable	The command centre for each session.	Choose or create a session (**+**); switch it **Active** / **Inactive**; delete a session; **Generate**; read the result report; department tabs; **Edit Slot** on drafts; **Publish All**; **Seat Assignments**; **Reset All**.
Students	The directory of registered students.	Search by name or matric number; filter by school, department and level; 50 per page. **View** opens a profile with enrolments; actions **Edit**, **Reset password**, **Delete**.
Advanced pages	Occasional fine-tuning, opened by typing the address.	`/admin/programmes`, `/admin/levels` and `/admin/slots`, for example to rename a programme or adjust a time slot.

The Timetable screen

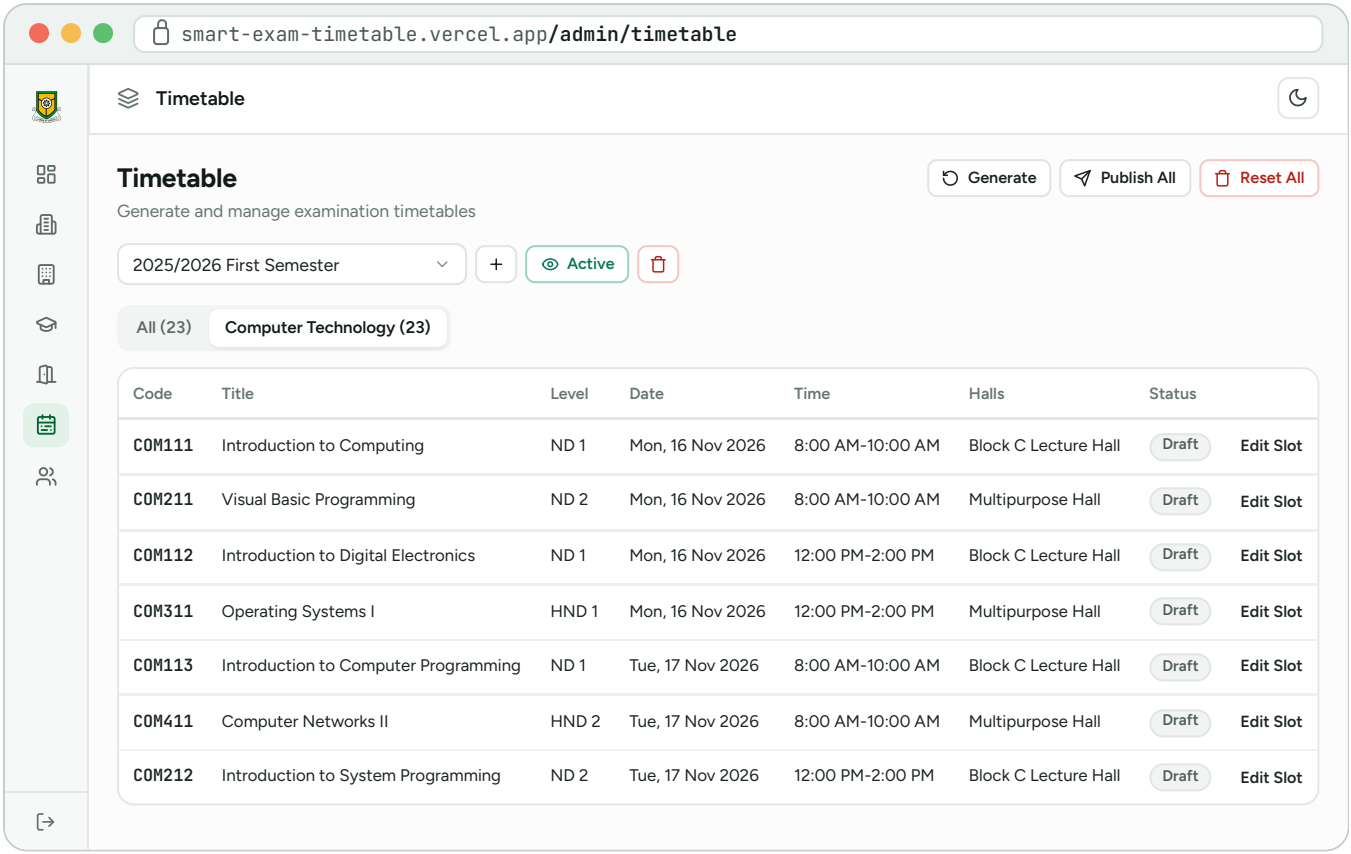


Figure 2. Timetable: session controls, toolbar, department tabs and a draft ready for review (sidebar collapsed). ILLUSTRATION (SAMPLE DATA)

Session controls

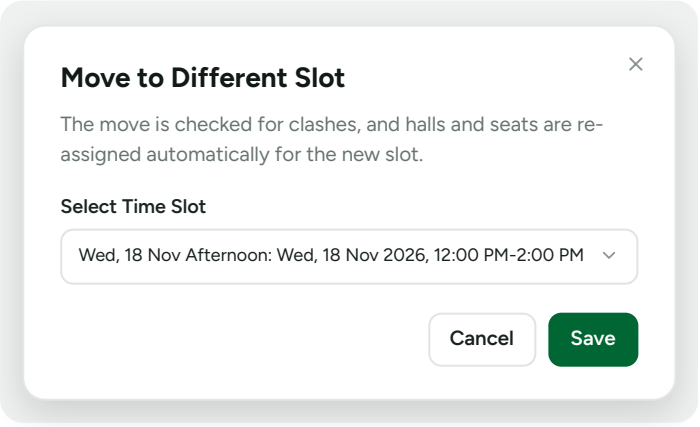
The session selector, **+** to create a session ("YYYY/YYYY First Semester" or "Second Semester"), the **Active** / **Inactive** switch (Active = visible to students) and the delete button.

Toolbar

Generate creates or replaces the draft; **Publish All** appears while there are drafts; **Seat Assignments** appears once published; **Reset All** clears the session's timetable.

Edit Slot

On a draft row, **Edit Slot** opens *Move to Different Slot*. Choose the new slot under *Select Time Slot* and click **Save**. The move is checked for clashes, and halls and seats in the new slot are re-assigned automatically. Published rows show *Locked* instead of Edit Slot.



Edit Slot on a draft row. · ILLUSTRATION

3 Running an exam period, step by step

From checking the structure to the last paper: the complete routine.

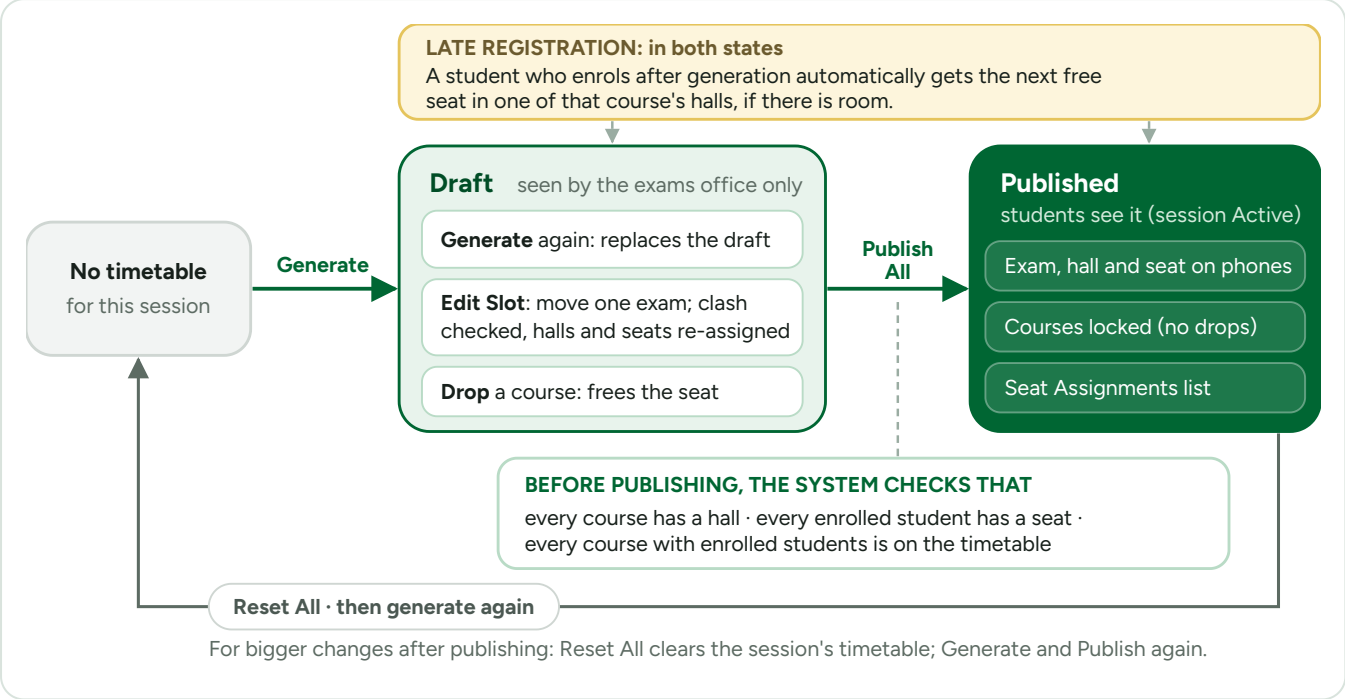


Figure 3. The timetable lifecycle you will follow: Generate a Draft, review and adjust it, Publish All, and use Reset All for larger changes.

3.1 Prepare: structure, halls and session

1 Check the academic structure

- **Schools** and **Departments** are in place. Adding a department creates its ND and HND programmes and the four levels automatically.
- **Courses** for the semester exist at the right levels, with the correct semester (First or Second) and credit units. Use **Upload CSV** for many courses at once (section 5).

2 Set up the halls

- For every venue in use: name, code, **real seating capacity**, latitude and longitude, a short description, and **Active**.
- Capacity drives seating; the coordinates place the hall on students' maps and walking routes.
- Set halls that are not in use to Inactive. They are left out of new timetables and hidden from students.

3 Create and activate the session

- On **Timetable**, click **+**, enter the start year and choose the semester, for example "2025/2026 First Semester".
- Make sure the session is **Active** so students can see it; set older sessions to Inactive.

4 Open the registration window

- Ask students to sign up at `/register`. Straight after sign-up they see their level's courses for the semester, all pre-ticked, and tap *Complete Enrollment*.
- Follow progress on the **Students** screen and the Dashboard's *Total Students*.

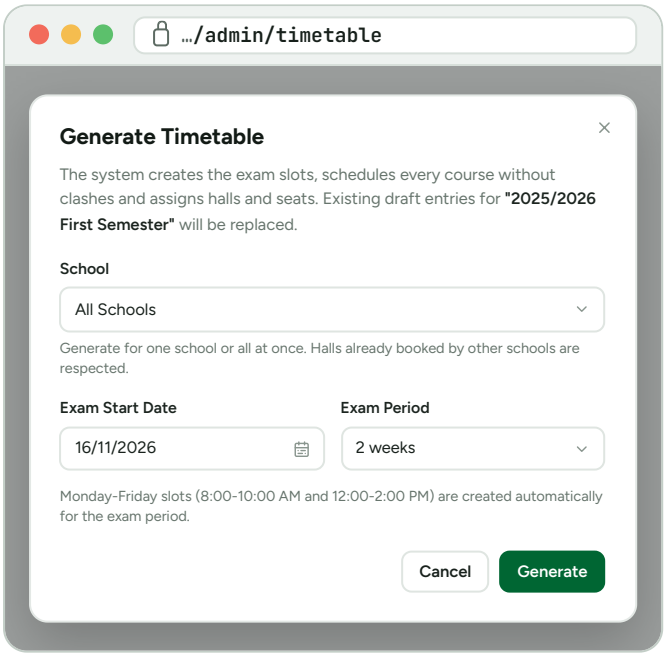
3.2 Generate and read the report

5 Generate the timetable

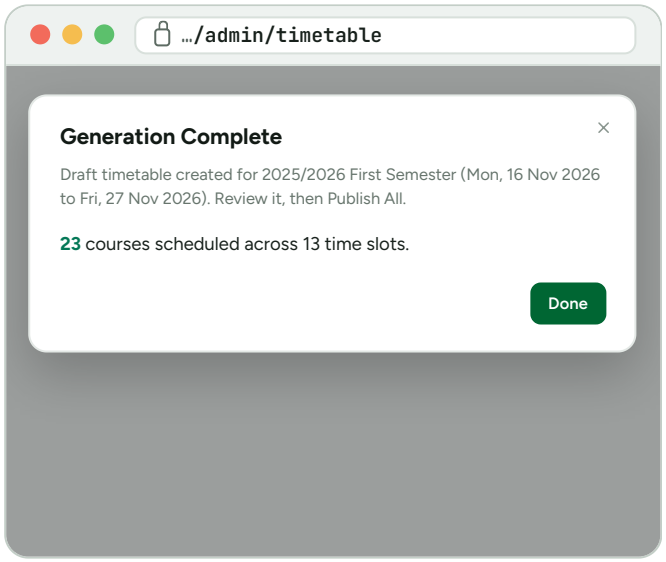
When registration has closed, open **Timetable**, choose the session and click **Generate**. The dialog has three fields:

Field	What to choose
School	*All Schools*, or one school. When you generate for one school, halls already booked by other schools' timetables are respected.
Exam Start Date	The first exam day (next Monday by default).
Exam Period	1 to 6 weeks (2 weeks by default). Monday-Friday slots, 8:00-10:00 AM and 12:00-2:00 PM, are created automatically: 2 weeks gives 20 slots.

Generating again replaces the existing draft entries for the session (or for the chosen school).



Generate: choose the school, first exam day and length of the exam period.



Generation Complete: the report. *Unresolved* and *Hall Overflow* lists are added only when something needs attention.

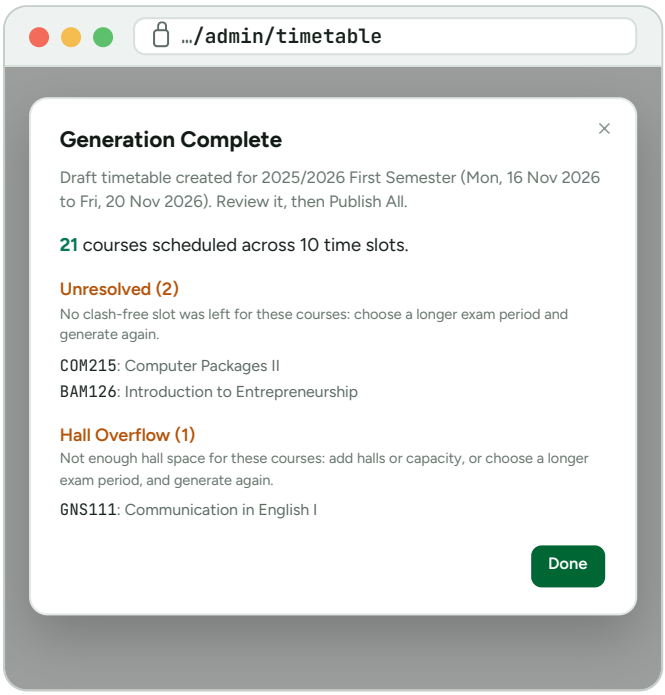
Figure 4. The Generate dialog and the result report.

ILLUSTRATION (SAMPLE DATA)

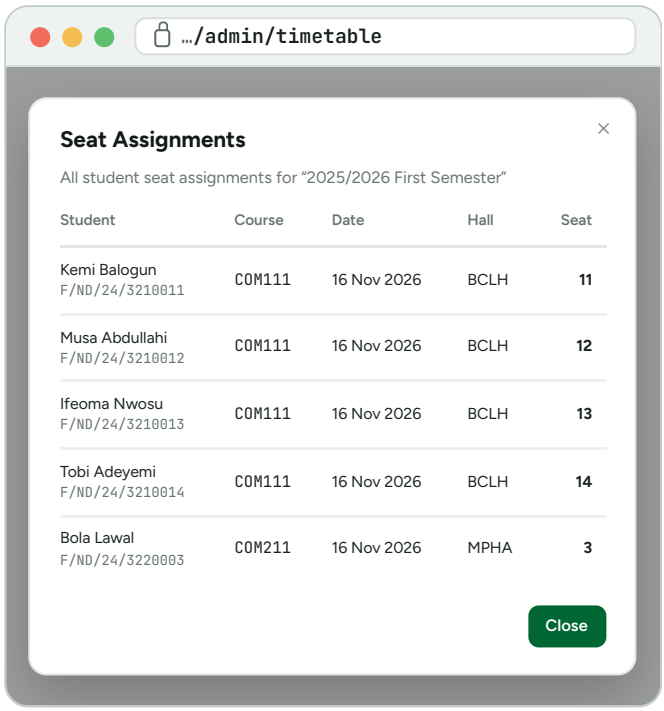
6 Read the report

"*N* courses scheduled across *M* time slots" confirms the draft. Two lists appear only when something needs attention:

- **Unresolved**: no clash-free slot was left for these courses. Choose a longer **Exam Period** and generate again.
- **Hall Overflow**: not enough hall space for these courses. Add halls or capacity (or activate a hall), or choose a longer exam period, and generate again.



When something needs attention, each list names the courses concerned and what to do.



Seat Assignments: every student's course, date, hall and seat, for invigilators.

Figure 5. A report with items to act on, and the Seat Assignments list. ILLUSTRATION (SAMPLE DATA)

3.3 Review, adjust and publish

7 Review department by department

Use the tabs: *All* and one per department, each with its number of exams. Check the columns Code, Title, Level, Date, Time, Halls and Status (Draft) for each department.

8 Adjust with Edit Slot

On a draft row, **Edit Slot** opens *Move to Different Slot*: choose a slot under *Select Time Slot*. The move is checked for clashes, and halls and seats in the new slot are re-assigned automatically.

9 Publish All

Click **Publish All** and confirm. The system first checks that every scheduled course has a hall, every enrolled student has a seat, and every course with enrolled students is on the timetable. When published, students with the session Active see their exams, halls and seats immediately.

10 Share Seat Assignments

Once published, **Seat Assignments** lists every student's course, date, hall and seat, ready for invigilators.

3.4 After publishing

Published exams are locked

Published rows show *Locked* instead of Edit Slot, and students can no longer drop published courses.

Late registrations are seated

A student who enrols after the timetable was generated automatically receives the next free seat in one of that course's halls, when there is room.

Bigger changes: Reset All

To restructure a published timetable, click **Reset All** and confirm, then **Generate** and **Publish All** again.

Visibility

Switching a session to **Inactive** hides it from students; switch it back to **Active** to show it again.

EXAM-PERIOD CHECKLIST

- [ ] Schools, departments and courses checked
- [ ] Halls: real capacity, coordinates, Active
- [ ] Session created and set to Active
- [ ] Older sessions set to Inactive
- [ ] Students told to register and choose courses
- [ ] Registration closed
- [ ] Generate: School, Exam Start Date, Exam Period
- [ ] Report read; Unresolved / Hall Overflow cleared
- [ ] Every department tab reviewed
- [ ] Publish All
- [ ] Seat Assignments shared with invigilators
- [ ] Students reminded to check Navigate before exam day

4 Managing students

Find any student, correct their record, reset a password or remove an account.

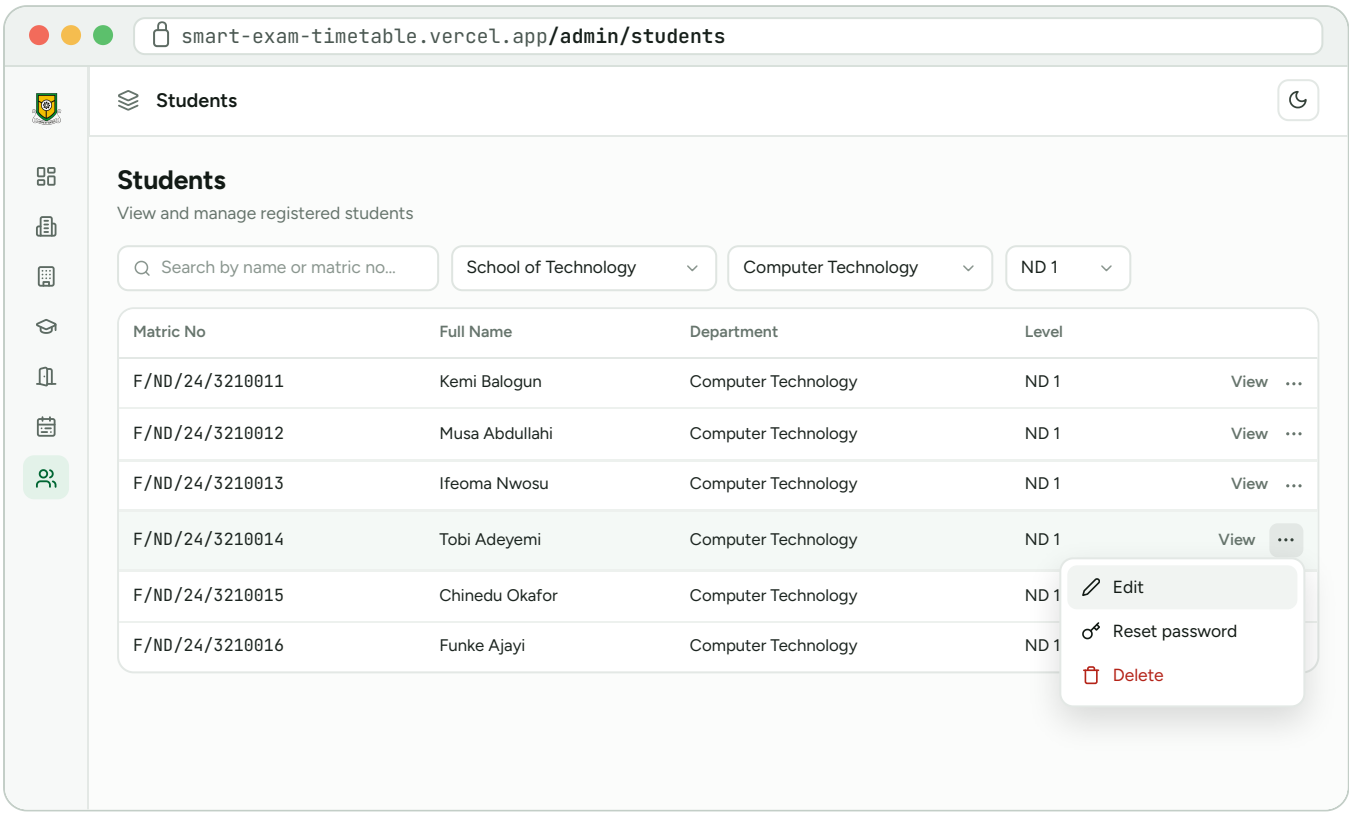


Figure 6. Students: search, filters and the actions menu on a row. ILLUSTRATION (SAMPLE DATA)

Task	How
Find a student	Type a name or matric number in the search box, and narrow by *All Schools* → *All Departments* → *All Levels*. Results come 50 per page.
View	**View** opens the student's profile: details, department, programme, level and enrolments, with the same Edit, Reset password and Delete actions.
Edit	Open the row menu (⋯) → **Edit**: Full name, Matric number, Email, and Department → Programme → Level. Matric numbers are stored in capitals and must be unique; a changed email also becomes the student's sign-in address.
Reset password	⋯ → **Reset password**: enter a New password and Confirm new password (at least 8 characters), then give it to the student privately.
Delete	⋯ → **Delete** and confirm. The student's record, enrolments, seats and sign-in account are removed.

TIP

If a student registered in the wrong department or level, **Edit** their record rather than asking them to register again. Their sign-in stays the same. They can then update their courses on the Courses tab.

5 Importing data from CSV

Add many departments or courses at once from a spreadsheet.

Save the spreadsheet as CSV (comma-separated values) with a header row, then use **Upload CSV** on the Departments or Courses screen. Header names are matched without regard to capitals, and quoted fields may contain commas. After each upload an **import report** lists what was imported, skipped or rejected, with the line number and reason for every rejected row.

Departments: `school_name,name,code`

school_name	name	code
School of Technology	Computer Technology	CSC
School of Engineering	Mechanical Engineering	MCE
School of Science	Statistics	STA

- Each new department is created with its ND and HND programmes and four levels.
- Rows whose department code already exists are skipped, so the same file can be uploaded again safely.

Courses: `course_code,course_title,department_code,level_name,credit_units,semester`

course_code	course_title	department_code	level_name	credit_units	semester
COM111	Introduction to Computing	CSC	ND 1	3	first
COM121	Introduction to Java Programming	CSC	ND 1	3	second
COM311	Operating Systems I	CSC	HND 1	3	first

- **level_name** is ND 1, ND 2, HND 1 or HND 2; **department_code** says which department's level is meant.
- **credit_units** is a whole number from 1 to 6; **semester** is *first* or *second*.
- Rows with an existing course code **update** that course; the report shows new, updated and rejected rows.

GOOD TO KNOW

Published timetables stay stable: a course that is already on a published timetable keeps its semester and level when a file is imported. To move such a course to another semester or level, use **Reset All** first.

6 Good practice

Habits that keep every exam period smooth.

Keep only the current session Active

Students then see exactly one session's timetable and courses, with no confusion between semesters.

Enter real capacities and coordinates

Accurate seat numbers keep classes in halls that fit; accurate coordinates give students the right walking route.

Generate after registration closes

Class sizes then match real enrolments, so halls and seats are right first time. Late registrations are still seated automatically when there is room.

Review every department tab

Look through each department before **Publish All**; use Edit Slot for small adjustments.

Deactivate rather than delete halls

Set halls you no longer use to Inactive: they leave new timetables and the students' list, while past records stay intact.

Choose a comfortable exam period

Two weeks gives 20 slots. If the report lists Unresolved courses, a longer period gives the engine more room.

Share Seat Assignments early

Once published, pass the list to invigilators so they can check hall and seat at the door.

Sign out on shared computers

Use **Sign out** in the sidebar footer when you leave an office computer.

7 Frequently asked questions

Quick answers to the questions exams officers ask most.

Q What does Hall Overflow mean?

There was not enough free hall space to seat the whole class for the listed courses. Add a hall, increase a hall's capacity, activate an inactive hall or choose a longer exam period, then click **Generate** again.

Q What does Unresolved mean?

No clash-free slot was left for the listed courses within the exam period. Choose a longer **Exam Period** in the Generate dialog and generate again.

Q How do I change a published timetable?

Published exams are locked. Click **Reset All**, confirm, then **Generate** and **Publish All** again. Small changes are best made with **Edit Slot** before publishing.

Q A student forgot their password.

Find them on **Students**, open the row menu (···) and choose **Reset password**. Enter and confirm a new password of at least 8 characters and give it to the student privately.

Q A student registered in the wrong level or department.

Choose **Edit** on their row and set the correct Department → Programme → Level. Their sign-in stays the same; they can then update their courses on the Courses tab.

Q Can I generate for one school at a time?

Yes. Choose that school in the **School** field. Halls already booked in a slot by other schools' timetables are respected, so schools can be scheduled one after another.

Q Why can't students see the timetable yet?

Students see only **published** timetables for **Active** sessions. Check that you clicked **Publish All** and that the session's switch shows Active.

Q A student enrolled after I generated. Do they have a seat?

Yes, when there is room: they automatically receive the next free seat in one of that course's halls. The seat appears in Seat Assignments and on the student's timetable.